Q+A

United in Music

National Award-winning composer **AMIT TRIVEDI** on his latest non-film, genre-agnostic album *Azaad Collab*, which features 22 artists



Q. What triggered this album?
This album is released on my label AT Azaad. In the past, I've done experimental albums, which were very niche. This time, I decided to go more mainstream by collaborating with the finest talents from the industry. I am so glad that A-list artists, from Armaan [Malik] to Jubin [Nautiyal], Sunidhi [Chauhan], Neeti [Mohan] and Neha [Kakkar] were all available. Not just recording with them in the studio, but sharing an entire day with them on set for the video was so wholesome.

Q. A surprising name on the credits is businessman Ajay Bijli, who's also sung a song!
Yes, and he's the only one on this album who I've collaborated with for the first time. He had approached me because he wanted to record a few songs. Until then I had no idea that he sang or was passionate about music. We recorded a few songs and all of them sounded really good. One of them, 'Beparwah', which has a light and breezy sound, perfectly fits this album's soundscape.

Q. What's changed for music over the past decade is social media and streaming platforms. But are algorithms killing music?
We are slaves to the algorithm. The world is consuming music either on YouTube, Spotify or similar platforms. It doesn't matter if music is ordinary or extraordinary, it just needs to be picked up by the algorithm organically. Or then, one has to feed the beast, which means making reels and short format content on a regular basis.

Q. Studio or stage—what is your happy place and why?
Definitely studio because everything starts there. Stage comes much later. It starts from the studio and ends on the stage—that's the journey. They're different ends of the spectrum and they're both equally important for every artist who's a singer or musician.

—with Karishma Upadhyay